

THE LONE WOMAN OF SAN NICOLAS AN EVALUATION OF THE BIBLIOGRAPHY WITH DISCUSSION OF THE HISTORICAL EVENTS

Juana María, an Indian woman, was "accidentally" left to her fate for eighteen years on the island of San Nicolas in 1835. The other remaining native inhabitants were removed to the mainland in 1835 on the *Peor es Nada*, Better-than-Nothing. No one seems to know exactly who instigated the removal.

Isaac Sparks had chartered the boat at Monterey, and with his group had gone otter-hunting in Lower California just prior to the tragedy. The accidental incident was apparently common knowledge, but not much attention was paid to this mother's plight by those responsible or capable of helping her.

The reason given for the hunters leaving the island so abruptly was that the day was increasing in storminess and there was fear of total disaster at sea. Perhaps the otter-hunters had intended to return for this poor soul, who had swum to shore in order to pick up her baby left in the hills. And besides, what was one or two Indian lives, as compared to the quest for quick profit.

No one will ever know exactly what happened on that fateful day or for the next eighteen years of the woman's life. In 1853 Nidever and Dittmann accomplished the mission of finding her and taking her to Santa Barbara, where she lived with the Nidever family until her death. By 1853, however, the Lone Woman was unable to communicate, and died shortly thereafter, probably from her inability to tolerate a change of diet.

We are left with any number of accounts, some quite fragmentary. The first complete reference did not find its way into print until three years after the Lone Woman was finally 'rescued' in 1853. This story came through Russell, "Narrative of a Woman who was Eighteen Years Alone upon the Island of San Nicolas, Coast of California," published by *Hutchings' California Magazine* [P27, 1856].

Russell's account was obtained from Nidever while they were both on the island of San Miguel, each pursuing his own business. It was even twenty-five years after the woman's rescue by Nidever and Dittmann that their separate interviews were recorded by Murray in 1878.

The following information presented to the reader is not a repetition of the story, but rather a discussion of the literature on the subject. Such literature is

sometimes contradictory in detail; but throughout the material the main threads of the incident remain intact. There will probably never be a completely accurate rendition of the Lone Woman story.

The reader is left to seek recommended references for a fuller accounting than given within these pages, or choose to glean from these evaluated references what was under discussion during that period of time. A chart at the end of the discussion is included; it should be helpful to the reader in identifying the various personalities involved.

Readers will do well to obtain the manuscripts of Nidever and Dittmann for their basics on the Juana María tale. These may be obtained through the Bancroft Library. Excerpts from such, as well as a compilation of the literature through Heizer and Elsasser [U13, 1961], are within comparatively easy access. Ellison [B51, 1937], contains the story of Nidever's life, and is another fine source for the Lone Woman.

Only one other recommended-for-reading account of the Lone Woman is Hardacre's "Eighteen Years Alone," published by *Scribner's Monthly* [P123, 1880]. The rest of the literature, although possibly furnishing some insights, are fragmentary or emersed in fanciful remarks that obscure the real story, and are therefore more questionable. However, they should be considered in the literature on the Lone Woman.

The author begins with the older references starting with the year 1893, which are basically the least acceptable, and moves toward the two manuscripts on Nidever and Dittmann, taken by E. F. Murray in 1878, the only first person accounts available.

Beginning with Gibbons' account, "The Wild Woman of San Nicolas Island" [P15, 1893], we find some unreliability, thus creating skepticism of his article. Gibbons said that the reason the story

can be so given now is due to the zeal and the thoughtfulness of Mr. D. W. Thompson, one of the fathers of the City of Flowers, and to him we are indebted for a decidedly curious page of history. In 1882 Mr. D. W. Thompson, accompanied by a shorthand reporter [unnamed], sought out those principal actors—the venerable pioneers George Nidever and Charlie Brown—and by elaborate questioning obtained full particulars connected with the unfortunate woman's career.

Gibbons' article was in no-less-than C. F. Holder's *Californian Illustrated*, 1893. Usually Holder can be relied upon for quality, with a little flair, but this

article is less than satisfactory; a mixture of fanciful quotes and statements; it ended with,

not until her very nature was so changed that she had become contented with her lot and had ceased her cry of "Manequauna" to the passing ships, were any measures taken to remove her from her rocky isle. Then they carried her off, unfortunate Juana María Better-than-Nothing! White men made her suffer. She lost her babe or babies; she lost her family; she lost the knowledge of her language; and at last, poisoned by the luxuries of a more civilized race, she lost her life.

This quotation alone gives Gibbons' article value in the literature on that poor soul, a human being, left by otter-hunters and others to her fate.

Herein follows a discussion of some of the little known local history for that period, which includes the name of D. W. Thompson, and others.

We are faced with the fact that we know nothing about Gibbons' source information, D. W. Thompson and the shorthand reporter, 1882. Was Thompson, for instance, Dixie [Dixey] Wildes Thompson, the nephew of Alpheus B. Thompson? This appears conceivable. Alpheus had been assured half-ownership of Santa Rosa Island through his father-in-law, Carlos Carrillo.

A Captain Dixey Wildes owned the *Paragon*, built in Massachusetts in 1815, with the *Paragon* doing business in sandalwood in the Sandwich Islands—as did the Winship brothers and Captain William Heath Davis, Sr. [See Gast, *Contentious Consul, A Biography of John Coffin Jones*, 1976.]

It was the *Paragon* of Marshall and Wildes that took John Coffin Jones to the Sandwich Islands in 1821, where Jones served as the business representative for the maritime merchantile merchants of that company. Jones also 'informally,' but directly, served as the representative for the United States as Consul.

It was Marshall and Wildes who made Alpheus B. Thompson a subordinate to John Coffin Jones, to serve as supercargo on several of the firm's vessels. Alpheus was being sponsored by his uncle, Captain Dixey Wildes [Gast].

In the meantime Alpheus moved to Santa Barbara and in the year 1834 Dixie Wildes Thompson began his career in Santa Barbara by working for his uncle, Alpheus B. Thompson, on the island of Santa Rosa [B53]. For such purposes Dixie Thompson had purchased the steamship, *Sophia*.

This Thompson, D. W., was one of those who later

laid a claim against J. C. Jones in the A. B. Thompson/J. C. Jones litigation suit, as did Luis Burton—only to find that such financial obligation for the care of livestock on the island was the obligation of A. B. Thompson, not that of J. C. Jones. Such are the ramifications of this period of history [Gast].

To keep the topic of D. W. Thompson completely unclear, we are given the information by Woodward [J367, 1938], that in his Southwest Museum researches he discovered an unpublished interview of George Nidever, made by a J. Terry in 1882. F. W. Hodge was Director of the Southwest Museum at the time that Woodward was doing some of his research on the Lone Woman.

Although this interview reference does not appear to have been used, could this J. Terry be the unnamed reporter connected with D. W. Thompson in 1882, and from whom Gibbons obtained his information?

Another article of questionable value is Stephen Bowers' 1892 account of "The Lone Woman of San Nicolas" [M27]. It was DeMoss Bowers, son of Stephen, who wrote to Dr. Alliot of the Southwest Museum in 1916, to remind Dr. Alliot that his father, Stephen, had sent his personal material on the Lone Woman to the museum.

Bowers' pamphlet is a reprint from the *Ventura Weekly Observer* under the dates of December 9, 16, and 20 of 1892 [M95]. Dr. Bowers was the editor of the *Weekly Observer*, having come West in 1869, living in the Santa Barbara/Ventura area between 1894 and 1906; deceased, 1907.

What is really important is a statement made by Rev. Bowers that

The account may also be found in the archives of the Santa Barbara Mission preserved by the Mission fathers. We secured a translation of their record of the event by a competent Spanish Scholar some fifteen years ago.

Although this mission record has not come to light, should we use Bowers' date of 1878, it would place this particular translation obtained from the Mission at about the same time as the E. F. Murray manuscripts on Nidever and Dittmann. In fact, the Mission story, if it does exist or were ever to be found, might contain many statements of fact on material that we do not presently possess.

We can short-circuit the Thompson and West account [B70, 1883], found in Chapter 17 of the book. According to the compilers of the book on the history

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of Santa Barbara and Ventura Counties, it was Dr. Dimmick, who came to Santa Barbara as a physician in 1872, who furnished the notes for their "The Lost Woman" story. The result is a combination of first and third person accounting.

Interestingly enough, Mrs. Emma Chamberlin Hardacre arrived in Santa Barbara in 1876, four years after Dr. Dimmick's arrival. In her account of the Lone Woman, as well as in Dimmick's, there are four Indian words given—"hide," "man," "sky," and "body." This could mean that one of their sources may have been the same, or that one could have used the material of the other.

Even though Mrs. Hardacre's "Eighteen Years Alone" is completely third person, her story is insightful. For comprehensive reading, no secondary account comes close to hers [P123, 1880]. With some drama, and perhaps a few misstatements, the account has real merit; she had interviewed Jeffries, Nidever, Dittmann, and others.

Nothing new is added through the *Pioneer*, "Left Alone on a Desert Island for Eighteen Years; California's Feminine Crusoe" [M84]. Furthermore, the date of publication, 1879, for this newspaper account, is too far removed from the actual occurrences to be of much value.

But both the title and the ending of Russell's account [P27, 1856], to be discussed later, leads one to feel that his material had been read by the *San Francisco Chronicle*—the *Pioneer* having obtained its writeup from the *Chronicle*, according to the *Pioneer*, 1879. Hardacre's title also carries some of the same words and might reflect that she, too, had read Russell.

We have been moving backward from 1893 to 1878, at which time the E. F. Murray reporting of interviews of Carl Dittmann and George Nidever surrounding the Lone Woman took place.

Ellison [B51, 1937], gives credit to the Bancroft Library for use of these two documents. He also states that his footnote material came from the *Pacific Historical Review*, and that his source for other material came from Dr. George Hammond and Vol. II of *New Spain and the Anglo-American West*. Thus we have some of the best thinking of this period.

At this point we reach a second detour in order to see the relationship of the various pieces of literature on the Lone Woman story and the historical events of that period. This refers specifically to Ellison [B51, 1937], Richard Henry Dana [B15, 1835],

H. H. Bancroft [B1, 1885], T. H. Hittell [B35, 1898], and others.

It was Ellison who stated that E. F. Murray was an assistant to H. H. Bancroft. Murray had been recommended by Judge Benjamin Hayes, friend of J. J. Warner [M96], to take the dictation from Dittmann and Nidever about the Lone Woman. Murray had taken such a type of dictation from many of the old residents of the area.

Three footnotes in Ellison are of interest. In footnote #1, readers are reminded that "John" Nidever was an uncle to young Nidever. But readers, at the same time, must be wary of the use of three given names for George Nidever. Both Dr. Stephen Bowers and Dr. Dimmick called George Nidever by the name of "John."

In *Masterkey*, Vol. 53, #4, we learn that Harrington referred to Nidever as "Jacob." Elsewhere, we are given the impression that the younger Captain George Nidever was a "Junior," which is apparently true [B56]. The other son's name, however, was "Jacob," or "Jake" [J282, 1930].

Footnote #87 states that A. B. Thompson was supercargo between 1831-1834 and up to 1838. He was also a shipbuilder. This brings up Nidever's statement that "For many years after the loss of the 'Peor es Nada,' the only craft on the coast were small boats to which the long distance and rough sea of the outer rim of the Channel would render a trip extremely dangerous." Yet statements of the known craft plying between the Sandwich Islands and our west coast, and the amount of otter hunting in the region of the Channel Islands gives lie to Nidever's statement. Even Wm. G. Dana owned the schooner *Santa Barbara*, said Bancroft, Vol. II. Indeed, Nidever was being generous, if not evasive.

Take, for instance, Richard Henry Dana's comments on this subject [B15], for the year 1835,

The second day after our arrival, a full-rigged brig came round the point from the northward, sailed leisurely through the bay, and stood off again for the south-east, in the direction of the large island of Catalina. The next day the *Avon* got under weigh, and stood in the same direction, bound for San Pedro. This might do for marines and Californians, but we knew the ropes too well. The brig was never again seen on the coast, and the *Avon* arrived at San Pedro in about a week, with a full cargo of Canton and American goods.

This was one of the means of escaping the heavy duties the Mexican lay upon all imports.

A vessel comes on the coast, enters a moderate cargo at Monterey, which is the only custom-house, and commences trading. In a month or more, having sold a large part of her cargo, she stretches over to Catalina, or other of the large uninhabited islands which lie off the coast, in a trip from port to port, and supplies herself with choice goods from a vessel from Oahu, which has been lying off and on the islands, waiting for her. Two days after the sailing of the *Avon*, the *lorriott* [sic] came in from the leeward, and without doubt had also a snatch at the brig's cargo . . .

John Coffin Jones owned both the *Avon* and the *Loriot*, perhaps even the unnamed Hawaiian brig, using Santa Catalina and "other of the large uninhabited islands which lie off the coast."

These statements lead to another footnote, #97, on the subject of *Peor es Nada*. It is said that the craft was twenty-ton, built in Monterey by Joaquin Gomez, and was launched on August 30, 1834 with Captain Hubbard in charge [B51].

Charlie Hubbard was German and a naturalized Mexican, who had come to California in the early '30s. In charge of the *Peor es Nada*, Sparks and Burton and others chartered it through Hubbard, going to Lower California in October of 1834.

Contained in the same footnote is the statement that John C. Jones chartered *Peor es Nada* during March of 1835 for the return trip from Lower California. Storke [B69, 1891], also remarked that the *Peor es Nada* "returned in March under John Coffin." This can only mean that Jones was involved with this first round trip—and could have been throughout this period of time.

The other sailing date for the ill-fated *Peor es Nada* was when "someone" took it back to Lower California in the "Autumn." And as Mrs. Storke put it, the *Peor es Nada* "returned in March under John Coffin, and made a second trip in the autumn."

This makes for an interval of time, between March and August, that is unaccounted for, in terms of what the men, Jones, Sparks, Isaac Williams, Burton, Francis D. Dye, Captain Marcus Harlow, *et al*, were doing with the *Peor es Nada*. Just otter hunting?

If the Indians on San Nicolas were picked up, and the Lone Woman left behind in August of 1835, this was done between the two trips to Lower California, not on one of them; March is in Spring and Autumn does not include August.

It was during September of 1835, after returning from Lower California and after Nidever and the

Black Steward had been picked up at Santa Barbara for their trip to Santa Rosa Island, that Sparks told Nidever of the Indian woman's abandonment.

With a load of lumber on board, the *Peor es Nada* continued its trip but capsized in San Francisco Bay, and nothing more was heard of her, but the Lone Woman story lingers on and on.

Nidever and Dittmann gave their interviews to Murray in 1878, long after Isaac Williams of Los Angeles had died, 1856; Robbins, likewise, in 1857, Wm. G. Dana in 1858, Isaac Sparks in 1867, J. C. Jones in 1861, and A. B. Thompson in 1869. This left only Burton, Nidever, and Dittmann as the living characters in Santa Barbara for this drama. Burton passed away in 1880 and Nidever in 1883.

Hubert Bancroft [B1, Vol. II], spells out some of the rudiments of Dittmann's life:

Dittmann (Carl), came to California in 1844, German sailor, known in Cal. as Charley Brown, who came on the *Euphemia*, engaged in otter-hunting with Nidever and others, an occupation interrupted by mining in '48-50. Sta. B. was his home town to '78, when he dictated for me his *Narrative of a Seafaring Life*, an interesting record of many adventures . . .

According to Hittell [B35], another historian of early California, Carl Dittmann was born in Prussia in 1822 and came to California in 1844. He was thirty-one years of age, as compared to Nidever's fifty-one years, when they went to San Nicolas to search for the Lone Woman. Dittmann used an alias (Charlie Brown), had been a deserter from an American whaler, and from Santa Barbara pursued the trade of an otter hunter.

It is hard to resist repeating some of the first hand, vivid material that comes to us. From Mrs. Brown, sister of Carl Dittmann, is this heart-string-pulling tale of a baby otter,

I have an otter skin which is fifty-seven years old. It was one of the last taken by my only brother, Charley Dittmann, who was hunting with Capt. George Nidever and his son, young George, in the waters of Lower California in 1865. He shot the mother otter and she had this baby in her arms.

She dropped it and as it was drowning my brother killed it. "See," said Mrs. Brown, displaying the skin, "how fine and glossy the fur still is. I have kept it wrapped up for a long time" [B56].

We refer again to H. H. Bancroft for another cap-

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sulated briefing, this time on Nidever:

Nidever (Geo.) came to California in 1833 . . . In '41 he married Sinforosa Sanchez, . . . piloted the U. S. coast survey craft in a survey of the Sta. B. islands '50; in '53 rescued the famous old Ind. woman of S. Nicolas Isl.; and about the same time bought an interest in S. Miguel Isl., where he raised stock for 17 years, and though wellnigh ruined by the drought of '63-64, sold out in '70 for \$10,000. In '78 . . . at the age of 76 . . . gave me a long and most valuable narrative of his *Life and Adventures* . . . He died in '83. A brother John, who died at Sta. B. in '73 is sometimes said to have come with Geo. but I think he came after '48. Another brother, Mark, was killed by the Ind. before reaching Cal.

The Santa Barbara Deed Book H tells us that Nidever and his two sons sold their interest on San Miguel to Hiram W. Mills for \$5,000.00. This transaction carried the date of May 8, 1867.

Nidever hunted otter, beginning his career in California with George Yount around San Francisco Bay. In 1835, and for about two years after, he was hunting otter under the Wm. G. Dana license, "Capt. Denny's." On other occasions he worked for A. B. Thompson.

It is stated in Ellison that Nidever purchased a schooner in San Francisco in 1850; Nidever uses the date of 1852 for that purchase. Nonetheless, by 1850 Nidever had an adobe hut on San Miguel Island and had stocked the island with sheep. It was probably on one of his trips to San Miguel to care for his business that he and Capt. Russell met, camped together, and discussed the Woman and how she had been abandoned on San Nicolas.

As we move away from 1878 toward the earlier period, we find in *Overland Monthly*, 1872 [P79], Josephine Walcott's "Hona Maria." Without too much to recommend "Hona Maria" Walcott is, nevertheless, imaginative and understanding when she says,

The effect of long seclusion upon her mind so crude and undeveloped, can not be conjectured. In her solitary abode she knew the ways of the birds of the air and fishes of the sea, and fashioned nets to capture them, which, with seals and roots, furnished her sustenance.

Now we turn to the earliest of records, 1841, and move toward the date of 1856 and C. J. W. Russell who wrote the first complete story about the Lone

Woman which was after her death in 1853.

We find for 1841, Phelps' "Logbook of the Alert," [U13]. It may be recalled that Richard Henry Dana returned to the East on the *Alert*, a sailing vessel belonging to Bryant and Sturgis, mercantile businessmen.

In the one paragraph that comes out of the Logbook bearing on the San Nicolas Island drama, we are told that Capt. Thomas Robbins called at the island with his 'vessel' in order to pick up the remaining inhabitants of the island.

This is the only mention of Robbins in any of the literature pertaining to the Lone Woman. A direct command from Robbins seems unlikely, for Sparks was supposedly working under the Dana license, not a Robbins license.

Actually, all five of Carlos Carrillo's sons-in-law or to-be-sons-in-law, were in the otter hunting business, some with licenses, with others doing illicit hunting and contraband trading. Since in business, "profit" was the name of the game, and the Indians on San Nicolas Island were seemingly the only Indian inhabitants left on the Channel Islands, could their presence have been an impediment to the smuggling business, for instance?

Dawson's *Memoirs* [B17, 1841], is well worth the reading, if for no other reason than to learn of Dawson's concern for his horse near starvation. It was James Alexander Forbes, English Consul from Mexico, who saved the day for the horse and Dawson's feelings about it, by caring for the creature.

In the little book Dawson speaks of his, Sparks, Nydever [sic], Dye, and Simmons having gone into partnership with A. B. Thompson for otter hunting. If Thompson was conducting business on a legal basis or not, it is not mentioned.

But through Gast's *Contentious Consul*, we have learned that Jones and Thompson were denied hunting licenses in 1831. They decided, therefore, to do illegal business and continued such into the middle '40s, at least. Dawson said, "We . . . killed several otter . . . We searched on shore for a lone woman . . . but failed to find her, although we found her tracks."

The third early reference to the Lone Woman comes from the *Overland Monthly* under the title of "A Woman's Log of 1849." The reference is given by A. Woodward [J367], and is taken from Vol. 16, 2nd series, July-Dec., 1890, pp. 273-280. A Mrs. McDougall was one of few women passengers in 1849 on the *California's* first trip to San Francisco. She

kept a diary, and on page 275 of this article Mrs. McDougall is quoted as saying,

In coming to Santa Barbara we passed an island about sixty miles from the coast, on which there is a lone woman living . . . Some three years ago they caught her, but she was perfectly wild and had lost her speech, so they left her.

Actually, when the Indian woman was taken off the island she was found to be of mild disposition and quite verbal.

Such material verifies the fact that knowledge concerning the abandonment was common. But some remained skeptical of her continued existence, Nidever being one. In Dittman's 1878 interview with Murray he said, "Nidever . . . was not very sanguine about finding her as he had come to the conclusion that the dogs had eaten her and was very doubtful if even her bones could be found . . ."

From the *Daily Democratic State Journal* of Oct. 13, 1853 we find these words,

The wild Indian woman who was found on the Island of San Nicolas, about seventy miles from the coast, west of Santa Barbara, is now at the latter place, and is looked upon as a curiosity. It is stated that she has been some eighteen to twenty years alone on the Island. She existed on shell fish and the fat of the seal, and dressed in the skins and feathers of wild ducks, which she sewed together with the sinews of the seal. She cannot speak any known language—is good-looking, and about a middle age. She seems to be contented in her new home among the good people of Santa Barbara.

This publication came out six days before the Lone Woman died of dysentery, from eating fruits and vegetables to which she was unaccustomed. Dr. Brinkerhoff attended her [P123].

Through Woodward [J367, 1938] we are told that the *Daily Alta California* in 1853 carried the story in November, concerning the Lone Woman's death, by making the announcement that on the evening of Tuesday the 15th of November there would be a Ladies' Fair and Raffle in the Musical Hall on Bush Street, San Francisco.

. . . a great variety of curiosities will be on exhibition, some of which, from their rarity and peculiarity, will be well worth the attention of the scientific and the curious. Some of the most singular objects will be disposed of by lot or raffle or as may at the time be thought proper and advisable. One of the most singular things

on exhibition will be the dress of an old Indian woman who for seventeen years lived:

Alone, alone, all, all alone
Alone in the wide, wide sea—
And ne'er a soul took pity on,
Her soul in agony.

This stanza is a fitting paraphrase from Coleridge's "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner."

Hutchings' California Magazine ran the first 'complete' story of the Lone Woman after she was found. Called, "Narrative of a Woman who was Eighteen Years Alone upon the Island of San Nicolas, Coast of California," it was published in November of 1856 [P27].

It was C. J. W. Russell who wrote the article, and he said that Nidever related it to him while they were on San Miguel Island. Nidever was otter hunting and tending his sheep there; Russell was doing tidal observations for the United States. The article is published in the third person, not the first person.

Immediately, various newspapers and others published the contents of the article. Questions relating to possible errors and omissions were promptly raised. Answers were categorically offered, and it was not until June of 1860 that the initial strength of human reaction tapered. In reality, Russell had but started further investigation, for in five ways his tale appears to be fiction and fact.

The San Francisco *Evening Bulletin* of November 25, 1856 [M69], recalled Capt. C. J. W. Russell's article in *Hutchings' Magazine*. Then the Los Angeles *Star* of December 13, 1856 carried the story through J. J. Warner of San Diego [M96].

The Honorable J. J. Warner had evidently written to the Los Angeles *Star* in 1856, presenting his version of the removal of the Indians from San Nicolas [M96]. But even though the newspaper used the words, "facts herein contained," for Warner's presentation, other newspapers and persons continued to question some of the 'facts.'

Albeit, Warner's version brings us somewhat closer to the shape of the story, even though the dates, the numbers exterminated on the island in previous years, and by whom, remained in question.

One statement can be categorically denied; the Lone Woman when found was not "old, infirm, and decrepid" and not suffering from hunger; malnutrition, no doubt. In the same vein, Putnam [N45], had called the Woman "an old hag."

Warner initiated the thought to the public that the decision for taking the remaining Indians from the

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island rested with two Los Angeles residents, not with the Mission fathers. Nidever added to this thought when he said, "I am sure Williams had an interest in the matter, as he afterwards took one of the Indian women to live with."

Hugo Reid wrote for the Los Angeles *Star*. In fact he had written a series of twenty-four letters about the southern Indians before his death in 1853. According to Alexander S. Taylor [M51], by 1860 Reid's material had already become scarce. It is entirely possible that J. J. Warner of San Diego kept in touch with many Indian events in and around Los Angeles through Hugo Reid's material.

We learn from *Pacific Discovery* [J83, 1960], that Reid was a Scot who settled in California in 1835. In 1837 he married a mission-trained Indian woman named Victoria, and Reid acquired a family by adopting her children from a previous marriage.

A few details may be mentioned about J. J. Warner. Six-foot-three inches tall, Don Juan José Warner appeared to be an educated man. He came from Connecticut in 1831, having been born in 1807 [B58, 1939]. By 1843 Warner had asked for a license so that he could hunt otter; he had hunted the poor creatures in 1831 with George Yount. By 1844, after having become a Mexican citizen, he was granted the Rancho Agua Caliente [B29, 1960]. In those early times his place was the first settlement to be reached by travelers coming over the desert from the Colorado River [B35, 1898]. By 1853, according to the *Daily Democratic Journal*, J. J. Warner had been elected to a San Diego judgeship.

Both Taylor's [U13] and the Sacramento *Union's* [M81] rehearsal of the Santa Barbara *Gazette* and the Los Angeles *Star* are substantially identical. The following came from the *Union*, as previously told by the *Gazette*,

In the year 1811, a ship owned by Boardman & Pope, of Boston, commanded by Capt. Whittemore, trading on this coast, took from the port of Sitka, Russian America, about thirty Kodiak Indians, a part of a hardy tribe inhabiting the Island of Kodiak, to the islands in the Santa Barbara channel, for the purpose of killing sea otter, which were then very numerous in the neighborhood of these islands. Capt. Whittemore, after landing the Kodiaks on the island, and placing in their hands fire arms and the necessary implements of the chase, sailed away to the coast of Lower California and South America.

In the absence of the ship, a dispute arose between the Kodiaks and the natives of the islands, originating in the seizure of the females by the Kodiaks. The Kodiaks, possessing more activity, endurance and knowledge of war, and possessing superior weapons, slaughtered the males without mercy, old and young. On the Island of San Nicolas, not a male was spared. At the end of a year, Capt. Whittemore returned to the islands, took the Kodiaks on board, and carried them back to Sitka.

This killing off of all males is in line with what the Logbook reported: two females and Black Hawk surviving. It also approximates Warner's statement of two females and two males having escaped the massacres. Neither statement is necessarily so; certainly they do not conform to Nidever's statement about Sparks and others having taken 17 or 18 Indians off the island in 1835.

And speaking of 'killing off,' Orr [B54], reminds us that there were more than 450 Northwest Indians and eighty Hawaiian hunters on the California coast between 1803 and 1811. And Adele Ogden [J93], said that the Russians were on San Nicolas Island for seven months in 1815. Perhaps the Pope and Boardman incident of 1811 was but one of many massacres.

Referring again to a later issue of *Hutchings'*, we note that the February 1857 article [P29], gives the *Gazette* credit for its addition to the 1856 *Gazette* story.

Hutchings' said that Captain Russell, who was from a family of whalers on the east coast [P28], went to Santa Barbara for a second meeting with Nidever. It was then that George Nidever gave to Russell a waterbottle made of grass and covered with asphaltum, a stone mortar, a necklace, and other things that had been made by the Lone Woman during her solitary stay on the island. The bottle and other articles were subsequently given to the California Academy of Sciences, March 30, 1857.

It is also through *Hutchings'* that the story is first mentioned about a good-sized cave which the Lone Woman had used for shelter. It is stated, also, that on the walls of the cave she had kept a rude record of passing vessels. Nidever corroborates that in the "rainy season she lived in a cave nearby." There is a nearby cave.

The March 30th, 1857, California Academy of Sciences tells about the disposition of Juana María's effects [J367]. Nidever verified the statement when

he said, "Her dresses, bone needles and other curiosities were taken possession of by Father González, with my consent, and sent to Rome."

Woodward [J367], contributes with the *Golden Era* reference of 1857. It relates the fact that Capt. Russell's financial offer to Nidever to display the Lone Woman in San Francisco and other towns was rejected. Capt. Trussil of Santa Barbara had also made a similar offer of \$1,000, according to Nidever in his report to Murray.

Tenney prefaces "Hermit of San Nicolas" [P112, 1907], by saying, "What little has been published about San Nicholas has long been out of print, and is now inaccessible to the reading public."

His writeup is fairly accurate, if not thorough. He used Thompson and West and the Boston paper's 1811 account of Boardman and Pope's trip to San Nicolas. But should there be a need to choose what is to be read, it would not be this 1907 version of the story.

O. M. Paul in 1911 used the same title as the 1853 *Daily Alta California*, "Female Robinson Crusoe." He told us that Jeffries went to San Nicolas a second time with Nidever to find the woman, but this cannot be substantiated.

It is interesting, however, that Paul began his article in a most unusual fashion,

It was at this time that the event occurred which the writer gives verbatim as told him by an old English sailor on the water front of New York City, at the time reporter on a daily journal of the great metropolis. The story was substantiated by an old log-book in the possession of the sailorman . . .

Since but one logbook reference exists, Phelps' of 1841, one wonders about this second reference some seventy years later. In some ways the account follows the salient facts rather carefully. Yet, one does wonder. Perhaps these words were but a journalistic beginning to an article, and should be dismissed as such.

There is a Stephen Bowers' file [M22] in the Southwest Museum. And in it is found a manuscript:

In November, 1915, I met at Alamos Harbor, Santa Cruz Island, George Nidever, 70 or more years of age. He was there (with his wife) engaged in crawfishing. His father, Capt. George Nidever, brought the lone Indian woman from San Nicolas Island to Santa Barbara in 1854. The son, though then a small boy, remembers

having seen the woman. Nidever told me that when he was about 10 years old he went to San Nicolas with Capt. who went there to kill the dogs on the island and that all were shot that could be found. I presume this was done so that the island might be safely stocked with sheep. He told me that the dogs were of the *Alaskan breed*!

This reference seems to be important for the Lone Woman story from but one standpoint: the name of one of the games being played by the actors in this drama could have been thoughts of "sheep raising on San Nicolas," not otter hunting, which instigated the removal of the Indians in 1835. The amazing thing about this above first-person comment is that the dates would place George Nidever and his son George on San Nicolas in 1857 for the dog-shooting—the same year that Kimberly probably left Santa Cruz Island for San Nicolas, which he stocked with sheep.

Dr. Jones had gone to both San Nicolas and Santa Rosa Island in 1901 for archaeological work. Seemingly, he felt that his knowledge of San Nicolas was above average for accuracy and quantity, and that it should be contributed in some manner. It was for that reason that he wrote to Lummis, editor of *Land of Sunshine*, to see if he would like to publish the material.

But we hear about Jones' contributions through the Southwest Museum's *Masterkey*, Vol. 43, 1969 [J207], and Heizer. It was Jones who furnished much of the material for the University of California's Archaeological Report #55.

In a footnote on page 87 of the Jones journal, Dr. Heizer said, "Deleted here is a lengthy account with long quotations from published sources of the Lone Woman of San Nicolas. All of these have been cited and reproduced [elsewhere]."

In this same *Masterkey* article, it was said that a Mr. Charles Merritt of Santa Barbara was the brother-in-law of M. M. Kimberly, and

In 1866 Mr. Merritt found a cave in which the lone woman had lived, and in it were a number of her former possessions, still in a fairly good state of preservation. He mentioned a garment of some sort, made of a kind of netting fashioned from sinew and covered with feathers fastened on with sinew, some arrow-points, stone knives, and a few abalone pearls. There were no pictographs or markings on the walls of the cave, at that time, though the walls were smoke-blackened.

PIECES OF EIGHT

- We can but wonder about two things: 1. When did Kimberly stock San Nicolas Island with sheep (Jones said about 1853), and 2. Why did the above quoted information not come sooner to the attention of others. There is a long stretch of time between 1866 and 1901.

The *Santa Barbara News Press* was the bearer of good news on February 20, 1944 [M93]. Research students at the Mission Santa Barbara discovered Juana María's burial record in the Mission archives. Where previously Father Engelhardt [B24, 1965], had said this record did not exist, it was finally located:

On the 19 of October of 1853 I gave ecclesiastical burial in this cemetery to the mortal remains of Juana María an Indian brought from the Island of San Nicolas, and since there was no one who understood her language she was baptised conditionally by Father Sánchez; and that this may stand as true I sign it. Father José María de Jesús González.

The entry is the 1,183rd in the record book and appears opposite page 114. Later [B24], Father Geiger made the remark, "When she died, González Rubio conducted her funeral services and buried her in the Mission cemetery. The location of her grave is unknown . . ."

Arthur Woodward [B62], said that in 1939-40 he went to San Nicolas Island. While there, he followed Ellison's account of the route taken in 1853 by Carl Dittmann and George Nidever while seeking the Lone Woman. They finally located her in the Corral Harbor area.

Woodward gave about fifteen pages to Juana María, sometimes using quotes from her discoverers, sometimes using third person. His bibliography is excellent, as well as his understanding of the subject matter.

Too many early Californians had found the islands to be lucrative. "Pieces of Eight," "Pieces of Eight," said the green parrot, the smuggler, the poacher, the fishermen, the otter hunters, and the stock raisers. And Juana María's life was caught in the cross current of it all. God rest your soul, Juana María!

LONE WOMAN

Abandoned, August, 1835

Found, August, 1853

Taken to Santa Barbara, end of August, 1853

JUANA MARÍA

Baptised by Father Sánchez, mid-October, 1853

Burial by Father González, October 19, 1853

Nidever plot, Mission cemetery

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*Note: Code number and date in italic indicates a work of superior importance.

Lone Woman Story, Characters

NAME: From	Married to	Trade, Remarks	Comments
DR. S. B. BRINKERHOFF, (1823-1880): New York, 1852 at age 29	Lucy A. Noyes, 1877 at age 54	Medical doctor; Tended Lone Woman until her death at Nidever home	"the silent benefactor of the poor . . . was threatened with financial ruin at the hands of those whose benefactor he had been. He never recovered from the shock; . . . We miss the enterprising citizen, the good doctor, the general companion, the true friend" [B70]
LUIS T. BURTON, (? -1880): Tennessee, 1831 w/Wolfskill party, settled in Santa Barbara	María Antonia, 1839 (2nd wife) niece of Carlos Carrillo	Mercantile business for 30 years, otter hunter, farmer	Nearly killed by robbers; nursed to health by Carrillos; with Sparks, 1835, removed Indians from San Nicolas; 1835, hunted on Wm. G. Dana license; 1860, bought "Burton Mound" from A. E. Hinchman (on beach); acquired wealth
WILLIAM GOODWIN DANA, (1797-1858): Originally from Boston, then Hawaii, 1826	María Josefa, 1828, daughter of Carlos Carrillo	Merchant, otter hunter, farmer, stock raiser	Cousin, Richard Henry Dana; Alcalde, 1836; held other offices; owned <i>Waverly</i> , 1827-28; built 33-ton schooner <i>Santa Barbara</i> , 1829, for trade and otter hunting; co-owner, <i>La Fama</i> , with Carlos Carrillo; grantee, Nipomo Rancho, 1837, 38,887.71 acres
DR. L. N. DIMMICK, (? -1884): Arrived California, 1872		Medical doctor	Thompson and West [B70], used Dimmick's notes about Nidever and the Lone Woman
CARL DITTMANN, (1822- ?): Prussia, 1844; alias "Charlie Brown"		Whaler-sailor, deserter, otter hunter	Instrumental in locating Lone Woman on San Nicolas Island. Interviewed by Hardacre
EMMA HARDACRE: Arrived California, 1876			Interviewed Nidever, Dittmann, Jeffries, <i>et al</i> ; wrote story of Lone Woman for <i>Scribner's Mo.</i> , 1880
JOHN COFFIN JONES, (1796-1861): Originally from Boston, commuted, 1830-1838, settled from Hawaii, 1844-46	Manuela, 1838 (1820-1900) daughter of Carlos Carrillo	Consul—Hawaii, merchant, otter hunter, ship owner	1821-30, representative, Marshall & Wildes, in Hawaii; wife was owner of ½ Santa Rosa Island and claimant for La Calera Rancho; chartered <i>Crusader</i> , 1832; chartered <i>Convoy</i> , 1832, 1834; on coast, 1830-40; co-owner, <i>Bolivar</i> (renamed <i>Oajaca</i>), 1843; owned brigs <i>Loriot</i> , <i>Volunteer</i> , <i>Louisa</i> , & schooners <i>Harriet Blanchard</i> , <i>Avon</i> , <i>Griffon</i> , <i>Rasselas</i> ; chartered cutter <i>Margarita</i>

NAME: From	Married to	Trade, Remarks	Comments
GEORGE NIDEVER, (1802-1883): Tennessee, Arkansas, 1834 w/Capt. Walker	Sinforosa Sanchez, 1841 (? -1892)	Trapper, bear hunter, Indian fighter, otter hunter, stock raiser, sheep grazer	Hunted on Wm. G. Dana license, 1835; promised land by Alvarado, 1836; promised ½ Huasma Rancho by Sparks; 1840, purchased "Burton Mound" from Joseph Chapman, sold to Hinchman, Santa Barbara attorney, 1850; 1850-70, w/ 2 sons, cattle and sheep on San Miguel Is- land; Thomas Robbins, his tenant; 1878, he and wife lived with young- est daughter just outside Santa Bar- bara; interviewed by Hardacre
THOMAS ROBBINS, (? -1857): Nantucket Island, 1827	Encarnación, 1834, daughter of Carlos Carrillo	Owned a store, 1830, 1st Mate, <i>Waverly</i>	Commanded <i>California</i> , 1837-39; grantee, Santa Catalina Island, 1846; grantee, Rancho Las Positas y Calera, adjoining Santa Barbara
DR. JAMES BARRON SHAW: England, 1853	Helen A. Green, 1861, Londoner	Supt., Santa Cruz Island Co., 1853-69, for Barron, Forbes & Co.	Had most stylish residence in Santa Barbara. Was seen by Lone Woman on arrival. He was on a horse
ISAAC J. SPARKS, (1804-1867): Maine, 1832 w/Ewing Young's 2nd trapping group; to Santa Barbara, 1833	Mary Ayers, Scottish	1836, owned trading store, otter hunter; see Santa Rosa Is., helped to remove Indians from San Nicolas	Built first brick house in Santa Bar- bara; was 1st Postmaster of Santa Barbara, 1836; purchased Julien Foxen home, 1843; grantee Huasmo Rancho though not married to a Californian; grantee, Pismo Rancho and 5 others
ALPHEUS B. THOMPSON, (1797-1869): Originally from Maine, commuted, 1825-34 from Hawaii to California	Francisca, 1834, (1815-1841) daughter of Carlos Carrillo	Merchant, otter hunter, farmer, stock raiser, supercargo, shipbuilder	Nephew of Capt. Dixie Wildes, un- cle of Dixie Wildes Thompson; wife was owner of ½ Santa Rosa Island; supercargo, <i>Washington</i> , 1825-30; co-owner & supercargo, brig <i>Boli- var</i> , 1832-40; owner of <i>Famer</i> (<i>La Fama?</i>), 1842; supercargo, <i>Loriot</i> , 1833-34
CAPT. ISAAC WILLIAMS, (? -1856): New York; from New Mexico with E. Young, 1832, to Los Angeles; called "Julian"	Antonia María de Jesús, daughter of Antonio Lugo	Farmer, trader, trapper, stock raiser	Collector for port of San Pedro; in- herited Chino Rancho, San Bernar- dino County, granted to Lugo, 1841; took an Indian from San Ni- colas, 1835, to live with him